

Combating discrimination in education

Tenth consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Approved by the UNESCO Executive Board at its 207th session in October 2019

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, respond to UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “*advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social*”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument providing for the **right to education** and the only one exclusively devoted to it.

The right to education is today one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community. SDG4 is rights-based and seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

The Convention has been recognized as a **cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda**. It also represents a powerful tool to advance SDG4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of national reports on the implementation of the Convention as well as the Recommendation in the context of the 10th Consultation.

2. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are obliged to incorporate its provisions into their national Constitution or domestic law. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain states might experience, in particular on account of their federal structure, in ratifying the Convention.

Bearing in mind the differences in wording and in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

Most importantly, the reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution states that “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*”. Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

3. Participation in consultations

In light of the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance in order to ensure an education that is truly for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. Concrete measures taken by Member States in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to this process.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG4 on education, efforts have also been made to ensure that the specific components are included in the guidelines and that the guidelines serve as a valuable monitoring tool for measuring progress towards SDG4 targets.¹ In addition, in view of the educational challenges posed by the influxes of refugees and displacements worldwide, the guidelines provide the opportunity to report on concrete measures taken during the reporting period to include refugees and migrants in their educational systems. An emphasis is also to be placed on legal and policy framework that protects the rights of national minorities.

The reporting should be as comprehensive as possible and the process needs to be **participatory** and conducted in cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education. Relevant information from CSOs having education as their main field of activity should also be provided.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

4. General indications

The reporting period for the 10th Consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2017-2020).

Member States that already reported to the 9th Consultation (2016-2017) are invited to **refer to their reports** when appropriate. Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are kindly requested to provide brief and concise information, although they may provide details on the scope of the question if deemed necessary. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

5. Modalities

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, two series of questions/remarks are presented:

¹ Please note that the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms is used specifically for monitoring SDG target 4.7. The 1960 Convention and Recommendation contribute more generally to the body of evidence for monitoring the targets of SDG4.

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States through a participatory process. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

In their responses, Member States are encouraged to provide information in a concise manner while preserving substantive and relevant content.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: Latvia

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: Ministry of Education and Science

I. Information on the legislative, judicial, administrative and other measures taken by the state at the national level

1. Ratification of the Convention²

Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ Yes

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country:

☐ Close to ratification

☐ Underway

☐ Actively under preparation

- Please briefly explain the difficulties encountered in completing the ratification process and the means of overcoming them:

Describe:

➔ *the obstacles, whether legal, institutional, political or practical*

➔ *the means of overcoming them and the extent to which UNESCO can assist in completing the process*

☐ No, not considering ratification in the near future. Please explain why:

2. Ratification of the Protocol³ instituting a Conciliation and Good Offices Commission to be responsible for seeking the settlement of any disputes which may arise between States Parties to the Convention against Discrimination in Education

Has your country ratified the Protocol?

☒ Yes

☐ No, please briefly explain the difficulties encountered:

3. Legal framework governing the protection of rights guaranteed in the Convention and the Recommendation in the national legal system

In case your country is a State Party to the Convention:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law following its ratification?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- If not, has it been incorporated into the national Constitution or domestic law so as to be directly applicable?

☐ Yes ☐ No

This seeks information on whether the provisions of the Convention are guaranteed in a domestic legal instrument. The report should list the main legal texts (Constitution, legislative text or other provisions) adopted to guarantee the right to education for all and to promote equal educational opportunities. References, dates and aims could be provided.

Article 112 of the Constitution of the Republic of Latvia states that anyone is entitled to education. The State shall ensure that anyone may acquire primary and secondary education without charge. Primary education shall be compulsory. At the same time, Article 99 provides that anyone is entitled to freedom of thought, conscience and religion.

Section 3, Paragraph one of the *Education Law* states that the following persons are entitled to education: 1) a citizen of Latvia; 2) a non-citizen of Latvia; 3) a citizen of the European Union, a citizen of the European Economic Area or a citizen of the Swiss Confederation; 4) a permanent resident of the European Community who has a valid residence permit in the Republic of Latvia; 5) a stateless person who has a valid travel document of a stateless person issued in the Republic of Latvia; 6) a citizen of another state, other than a citizen of the European Union, the European Economic Area or the Swiss Confederation or a stateless person who has a valid residence permit in the Republic of Latvia; 7) a refugee or a person who has acquired alternative status; and 8) a person who has received temporary protection in the Republic of Latvia. In turn, Paragraph two of the said Section states that a minor child of an asylum seeker and a minor asylum seeker is entitled to basic education and secondary education, as well as the right to continue the commenced education after reaching the age of majority.

Pursuant to Paragraph three of the same Section, a minor third-country national or a stateless person who has no legal basis to reside in the Republic of Latvia is entitled to acquire basic education during the time period specified for voluntary exit or during the time period for which the expulsion is suspended, as well as during his or her detention. <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law>.

Pursuant to Section 3.¹, Paragraph one of the *Education Law*, a prohibition of differential treatment has been stipulated, thus guaranteeing the persons referred to in Section 3 of the Education Law the right to acquire education regardless of the material and social status, race, nationality, ethnic origin, gender, religious and political affiliation, state of health, occupation and place of residence. <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law>

As the aforementioned provisions of the *Education Law* are binding in the implementation of education at all its levels and in all types of education in accordance with Paragraphs 5 and 6 of the *Education Law*, as well as in the application of the norms of the *General Education Law*, the *Vocational Education Law* and the *Law on Institutions of Higher Education*, one could conclude that the *Convention* is being complied with in the implementation of the national educational policy.

Section 9, Paragraph 7 of the *Asylum Law* states that the Cabinet shall determine the procedures by which a minor asylum seeker shall be provided with opportunities for acquiring education. On the basis of the foregoing, the Cabinet has issued Regulation No 488 of 26 July 2016 "Procedures for the Provision of Minor Asylum Seekers with Opportunities for Acquiring Education". <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/283808-procedures-by-which-minor-asylum-seeker-shall-be-provided-with-opportunities-for-acquiring-education>

- Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked before and given effect to by courts, tribunals and administrative authorities?

x Yes ☐ No

If yes, please illustrate on the basis of available case law and jurisprudence. Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the rights guaranteed by the Convention and the scope of such competence.

In case your country is not a State Party to the Convention:

- Have legislative measures been taken pursuant to the Recommendation?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, the report could list the main texts adopted to guarantee the right to education for all and to promote equal educational opportunities. References, dates and aims could be provided.

- Please explain briefly the extent to which public policies and programmes correspond to the general provisions of the Recommendation.

Information supplied could demonstrate how such policies and programmes comply with commitments of the right to education under the Recommendation.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation

1. Non-discrimination and equal opportunities in education in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-discrimination and equal opportunities in education. This part relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity.

*This corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “**ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all**” by 2030. It therefore covers all the SDG4 targets, but also specifically SDG target 4.5.⁴*

- 1.1 Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation (please tick all that apply)⁵ (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☐ Constitutional laws and/or legislation prohibit discrimination in education
- ☐ Regulations prohibit discrimination in education
- ☐ Policies and programmes aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education
- ☐ Access to justice in case of violations of the right to non-discrimination in education
- ☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum
- ☐ Other:

⁴ Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

⁵ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on:

- ➔ *Non-discrimination in the admission of pupils to educational institutions*
- ➔ *Non-differential treatment, including of foreign nationals resident in your country*

General requirements regarding the prohibition of differential treatment in education have been laid down in Section 3.¹ of the *Education Law* (see Section I, Paragraph 2).

The Latvian state has a unified educational system, uniform standards for academic subjects and sample curricula for all educational institutions. The standard for each academic subject includes questions relating to civic education and value education, tolerance and respect for difference. The Ministry of Education and Science supports the implementation of various educational programmes in order to meet the needs of every student, while observing the prohibition of discrimination based on gender, age, race, citizenship, ethnic origin and religious persuasion.

Article 14(2) of the Framework Convention for the Protection of National Minorities states that, if there is sufficient demand, persons belonging to national minorities have adequate opportunities for being taught the minority language or for receiving instruction in this language. In the Latvian state, every pupil has the opportunity to choose an educational institution irrespective of the language of instruction.

Section 38 of the Education Law states that educational programmes for ethnic minorities is one of the specific types of educational programmes. In developing educational programmes, educational institutions may incorporate into them the educational content necessary for the acquisition of the respective ethnic culture.

Section 8, Paragraph three, Clause 4 of the *Asylum Law* states that the Cabinet shall determine the procedures by which a minor asylum seeker shall be provided with opportunities for acquiring education. On the basis of the foregoing, the Cabinet has issued Regulation No 488 of 26 July 2016 "Procedures for the Provision of Minor Asylum Seekers with Opportunities for Acquiring Education".

The criteria and procedures by which students are enrolled in and discharged from general educational institutions have been laid down in Regulation No 591 of 13 October 2015 Procedures for Enrolling Students in and Discharging from General Educational Institutions and Special Pre-school Educational Groups, and also for Moving Them up into the Next Grade.

1.2 Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☒ Constitutional laws and/or legislation guarantee equal access to education
- ☒ Regulations ensure equal access to all levels and types of education
- ☒ Policies and programmes ensure equal access to all levels and types of education
- ☐ Other:

- Please indicate the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts and provide a brief description of the measures taken:

This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b⁶

Article 112 of the Constitution of the Republic of Latvia states that anyone is entitled to education. The State shall ensure that anyone may acquire primary and secondary education without charge. Primary education shall be compulsory. At the same time, Article 99 provides that anyone is entitled to freedom of thought, conscience and religion. Section 3, Paragraph one of the Education Law states that the following persons are entitled to education: 1) a citizen of Latvia; 2) a non-citizen of Latvia; 3) a citizen of the European Union, a citizen of the European Economic Area or a citizen of the Swiss Confederation; 4) a permanent resident of the European Community who has a valid residence permit in the Republic of Latvia; 5) a stateless person who has a valid travel document of a stateless person issued in the Republic of Latvia; 6) a citizen of another state, other than a citizen of the European Union, the European Economic Area or the Swiss Confederation or a stateless person who has a valid residence permit in the Republic of Latvia; 7) a refugee or a person who has acquired alternative status; and 8) a person who has received temporary protection in the Republic of Latvia. In turn, Paragraph two of the said Section states that a minor child of an asylum seeker and a minor asylum seeker is entitled to basic education and secondary education, as well as the right to continue the commenced education after reaching the age of majority. Pursuant to Paragraph three of the same Section, a minor third-country national or a stateless person who has no legal basis to reside in the Republic of Latvia is entitled to acquire basic education during the time period specified for voluntary exit or during the time period for which the expulsion is suspended, as well as during his or her detention. <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law>. Section 9, Paragraph 7 of the Asylum Law states that the Cabinet shall determine the procedures by which a minor asylum seeker shall be provided with opportunities for acquiring education. On the basis of the foregoing, the Cabinet has issued Regulation No 488 of 26 July 2016 "Procedures for the Provision of Minor Asylum Seekers with Opportunities for Acquiring Education". <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/283808-procedures-by-which-minor-asylum-seeker-shall-be-provided-with-opportunities-for-acquiring-education>

1.3 Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> x Providing financial incentives and fellowships x Providing positive or affirmative action measures x Ensuring inclusion in mainstream schools for all learners x Training teachers on inclusive education x Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) and technical and vocational training (TVET) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Providing auxiliary assistance x Adapting education infrastructure x Adapting curricula and methods ☐ Providing language classes to newcomers (e.g. refugees) ☐ Eliminating administrative barriers to education⁷ x Providing flexible learning pathways X Valuing diversity in schools x Combatting stereotyping and stigmatisation |
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⁶ Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes".

⁷ Administrative barriers to education include, amongst others, lack of identity papers or birth certificates required to enrol.

- ☐ Providing re-entry programmes for young mothers
- ☐ Eliminating all barriers for pregnant girls or young mothers in education
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken, including those to ensure *gender equality and the empowerment of girls and women in and through education*:

According to the Ministry of Education and Science data, in academic year 2018/2019 in primary and secondary education were enrolled 49 percent of girls and 51 percent of boys. In primary and secondary education 52 percent of students taking courses in the science programs were girls. Based on the enrolment and graduation of female students in the higher education we can see that **women** are choosing programs in natural sciences, mathematics, information technology, engineering, manufacturing and construction almost one third of the student body taking these programs.

- Please indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age for marriage so that it conforms to international standards (18 years):

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

Yes x No ☐

Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:

According to Civil Law Section 32 Marriage prior to the attaining of eighteen years of age is prohibited except for a person who has attained sixteen years of age may marry with the consent of his or her parents or guardians if he or she marries a person of age of majority. If the parents or guardians, without good cause, refuse to give permission, then permission may be given by an Orphan's court for the place where the parents or appointed guardians reside. <https://likumi.lv/doc.php?id=90223>

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education in the context of SDG 4

2.1 Pre-primary education

Pre-primary education is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of early childhood care and education (ECCE) over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized "the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth" (General Comment 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to "the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education".

⁸ Which states that "ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development".

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country?

X Pre-primary education is compulsory: Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

At the age 5 and 6 education is compulsory

X Pre-primary education is free of charge for all: Please provide the duration:

From 1,5 year - 5 years

- Please list the laws and policies that ensure the availability of pre-primary education for all and provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of access to pre-primary education. Brief quantitative information could be added.

Education Law Chapter IV <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law> The educational content in basic education and general secondary education is unified for all pupils, and it has been specified in Cabinet Regulation No 716 of 21 November 2018 "Regulations Regarding the Guidelines for the State Pre-School Education", Cabinet Regulation No 747 of 27 November 2018 "Regulations Regarding the State Basic Education Standard and Basic Education Subject Standards" and Cabinet Regulation No 416 of 3 September 2019 "Regulations Regarding the State General Secondary Education Standard and General Secondary Education Subject Standards". on 1 September 2004 - in State and local government general secondary education institutions which implement minority education programmes, commencing from the tenth grade, learning shall take place in the official language according to the State general secondary education standard; in State and local government vocational education institutions commencing from the first academic year learning shall take place in the official language according to the State professional education standard or the State vocational secondary education standard. The State general secondary education standard, the State professional education standard, and the State vocational secondary education standard shall specify that the acquisition of the learning content in the official language shall be ensured for not less than three-fifths of the total lesson load in the academic year, including foreign languages, and shall ensure that content related to the minority language, identity and culture shall be taught in the minority language

2.2 Universal primary and secondary education

Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide "12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory."

Primary education

- Is primary education compulsory in your country?

x Yes ☐ No

Please indicate the current duration period of compulsory education and the age of enrolment:

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of universal access to primary education. Quantitative information could be added.

362 primary educational institutions implemented the education programme in Latvian and minority education programmes (study language: Russian; Polish; Ukrainian, Belorussian, Hebrew , Lithuanian; Estonian.

Primary education is mandatory and is free of charge. Enrollment starts in a year when child becomes 7 years old. Duration: grade 1 to grade 9 (Chapter VI of Education Law) <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law>

- Is primary education available free of charge to all?

X Yes: Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is.

For this, please list the laws and policies that ensure the universal and free availability of primary education and indicate whether direct and indirect costs are charged (such as tuition fees, exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport costs and compulsory levies on parents).

Grades 1-9

☐ No: Is your country already engaged in legal and policy reforms to work towards universal and free primary education?

☐ Yes ☐ No

• Please briefly provide information on the reforms taken:

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training in your country.

- Is secondary education (middle/high) available free of charge?

xYes: Please provide the duration and describe the extent to which it is.

Please list the laws and policies that ensure the free availability of secondary education and describe whether direct and indirect costs are covered (such as tuition fees, exam fees, school supplies, uniforms, transport costs and compulsory levies on parents).

Grades 10 -12

X No Is secondary education (middle/high) compulsory in your country?

What are the measures your government intends to take to ensure free secondary education?

- Is secondary education (middle/high) compulsory in your country?

☐ Yes x No

- Please provide details on its implementation and indicate the duration of compulsory secondary education and the age of enrolment:

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of universal access to secondary education. Quantitative information could be added.

254 secondary educational institutions implemented the education programme in Latvian and minority education programmes (study language: Russian; Polish; Ukrainian, Belorussian, Hebrew, Lithuanian; Estonian.

According to Chapter VII of Education Law, Secondary education is free of charge. A private educational institution may determine a fee for the acquisition of education. Enrolment grade 10 to grade 12. <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law> Chapter VII

- Indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age of entry into employment so that it is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

Please note that minimum age labour laws and those related to compulsory education interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes x No ☐

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:

According to Section 37(1) of Labour Law, it is prohibited to employ children under 15 years of age and who until reaching the age of 18 continues to acquire a basic education, in permanent work. <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/26019-labour-law>

2.3 Higher education

Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3⁹, and target 4.4¹⁰.

- Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation¹¹ to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational education and training (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

x Constitutional laws and/or legislation prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training

⁹ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

¹⁰ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

¹¹ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

- x Regulations prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training
- x Policies and programs aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training

☐ Other:

- Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on:

➔ *Non-discrimination in the admission of students to higher education institutions on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation*

➔ *Non-differential treatment, including of foreign students*

Article 112 of the Constitution of the Republic of Latvia states that anyone is entitled to education. Education Law <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law>: Section 3. Right to Education (1) The following persons have the right to education: 1) a citizen of Latvia; 2) a non-citizen of Latvia; 3) a citizen of the European Union, a citizen of the European Economic Area or a citizen of Swiss Confederation; 4) a permanent resident of the European Community who has a valid residence permit in the Republic of Latvia; 5) a stateless person who has a valid travel document of the stateless person issued in the Republic of Latvia; 6) a citizen of another state, other than a citizen of the European Union, the European Economic Area or Swiss Confederation (hereinafter – a third-country national) or a stateless person who has a valid residence permit in the Republic of Latvia; 7) a refugee or a person who has acquired alternative status; 8) a person who has received temporary protection in the Republic of Latvia. (2) A minor child of an asylum seeker and a minor asylum seeker has the right to basic education and secondary education, as well as the right to continue the commenced education after reaching the age of majority. (3) A minor third-country national or stateless person who has no legal basis to reside in the Republic of Latvia, has the right to acquire basic education during the time period specified for voluntary exit or during the time period for which the expulsion is suspended, as well as during his or her detention. Section 3. Prohibition of Differential Treatment (1) The persons referred to in Section 3 of this Law have the right to acquire education regardless of the material and social status, race, nationality, ethnic belonging, gender, religious and political affiliation, state of health, occupation and place of residence. Plan for the Promotion of Equal Rights and Opportunities for Women and Men for 2018-2020 which includes: promotion of equal educational opportunities for boys and girls, men and women National Development Plan 2021-2027 Inclusive educational environment [174] Educational institutions need a physically and emotionally safe and supportive environment as well as a system and conditions supportive of every child's learning and development, including inclusiveness of children and youths with special needs, support to children and youths at socio-economic risk and elimination of emotional and physical violence. [180] Ensuring individual and institutional support to children and youths subject to socio-economic risks and abuse (new parents, students from poor and socially vulnerable families, children of migrants and remigrants) by providing material (scholarships, coverage of transportation, meals and dormitory expenses) and other kind of support (language learning, psychological support, etc.). [181] Environmental adjustments in educational institutions, development and provision of special teaching materials and other support to children and youths with disabilities and special needs. Educational Development Guidelines 2014-2020 which aim to strengthen a supportive and inclusive environment for education through gender equality.

- Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”.

- ☐ Higher education is generally free of charge
- ☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on the measures taken and provide brief information on the financial costs to receive education in higher public or private education institutions, if higher education is not free of charge.

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government as regards access to higher education and on the progress realized. Quantitative information could be added.

Students do not pay tuition fees if they enrol in a state education institution and are accepted in a budget study place based on merit. 43.1% of all study places in the country (in all public and private universities and colleges together) are funded by the state budget. Scholarships, grants and other incentives are merit-based and awarded based on a competition if the number of scholarships is limited. However, if there are two equal candidates for a scholarship, the priority is given to the candidate with disability or any other special need if applicable. Individual institutions may offer a very limited number of scholarships to support high performing students in need or award a one-time stipend based on a student's socio-economic status. Students in good standing can apply for state guaranteed loans.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- x Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- x Provision of literacy programmes
- ☐ Provision of appropriate learning and life-skills programmes
- x Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- x Provision of flexible learning pathways
- x Provision of professional training and qualifications
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

According to the Constitution of Latvia (*Satversme*) the State ensures that everyone, inter alia irrespectively of age, may acquire primary and secondary education without charge. Second chance education are provided in evening or extramural education programmes, including in the form of distance learning. In 2019/2020 study year 46 schools offered evening and extramural education programmes. On September 1, 2019 2051 students were in evening education programmes and 7058 – in extramural (Approximately 4% of all students). Most of them were adults.

On 15 July 2016, the Regulation of the Cabinet of Ministers No.474 “Implementing rules of the Operational programme “Growth and Employment” 8.4.1. Specific objective Project “To develop professional competencies of employees” was adopted to provide a support for improvement of professional competences of employed young persons (age 17-24) and employed adults (age 25+) with a special focus on workers in high social risk groups including those over 45 and the low-skilled.

Within the framework of the project, adults can acquire continuing vocational education, vocational training and non-formal education programmes, modular VET programmes, to receive career counselling services, validation of professional competences acquired outside formal education settings. The project supports participation in education programmes with 5% co-payment. For the low-income adults and for adults with disabilities the participation is free of charge. The implementation of additional support measures is foreseen for persons under the risk of social exclusion in the form of provision of the necessary assistant service for disabled persons and support for regional mobility for low-income or poor workers.

More than 34,000 workers have started, of which more than 23,000 have already completed their education. 31% of all participants are over the age of 45, while 19% are over the age of 50. In total, it is planned to involve 53 thousand employees in the project by 2023. The duration of the project: from December 2016 to December 2023 (In 2020 the project was prolonged for one year until December 2023 and the funding for the project has been increased by more than 21 million EUR, reaching almost 47 million EUR in total.

Since 2011 the vocational training, upskilling programmes and non-formal education programmes are implemented with the voucher method. The training vouchers are issued by State Employment Agency (SEA) for unemployed who meet the eligibility criteria. Vouchers can be used to choose a training organized by training providers. Participation in training is free of charge. Total number of entrants in training measures (vocational continuing and upskilling programmes; non-formal training (ICT, state and foreign

languages); trucks and vehicle courses) in 2018 and 2019 were 35 046 unemployed and job seekers. Involvement in short training programmes for gaining basic skills and competencies including e-learning courses on topics such as financial literacy and preparing for interviews in 2018 and 2019 were 61 545 (non-unique participants).

Other sectoral ministries, e.g. the Ministry of Economics, the Ministry of Interior, the Ministry of Defence, the Ministry of Justice etc., also provide specific education and training activities for the employed in appropriate sectors of economy.

Latvian education system is flexible with high permeability.

Short cycle vocational education (VET) programmes are available for the NEET youth.

Within the ESF project 8.5.2. SO "Ensure that vocational education and training is in line with the European Qualifications Framework" the modularization of the VET programmes are ongoing. By June 2020 modular programs for 122 qualifications are finished. 28 vocational education institutions have been involved in the implementation of modular vocational education programmes covering all sectors.

Opportunities to obtain professional qualifications through recognition and validation of knowledge and skills are provided since 2011. 7190 adult persons (2 712 persons for the period 2017-2020) received qualification approving their skills and knowledge acquired out of formal education settings, including in daily life. Contracts with education institutions agreed on recognition and validation for more than 330 professional qualifications. With the support of SF project "To develop professional competencies of employees" this service is also available for employees at a reduced fee - 10 percent of full payment.

2.5 Quality education provision and learning environment

Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to "build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all".

- Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure equivalence in all educational institutions with regard to (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- x Establishment of minimum norms and standards in education
- x Establishment of conditions relating to the quality of the education provided (e.g. infrastructure, learner/teacher ratios, teaching and learning materials, use of ICT)
- x Adoption of legal or regulatory provisions to ensure that children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools).

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

To provide such quality assessment, please take into account all educational institutions of the same level. You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

In order to ensure a safe learning environment, special attention is paid to the quality assessment process of educational institutions (accreditation). It is determined by the Cabinet of Ministers on 20.12.2016. regulations No.831 "Procedures for the Assessment of Professional Activities of Educational Institutions, Examination Centres, Other Institutions specified in the Education Law, Accreditation of General and Vocational Education Programmes and Managers of Educational Institutions". Among other things, educational institutions are evaluated in the following criteria: psychological and social pedagogical support for learners, guaranteeing the safety of learners, supporting the personality of

learners, supporting students with special needs, the environment of the educational establishment (microclimate). Educational institutions themselves determine how to ensure a safe environment, as well as action in case of violations, based on regulatory regulations. For example, security requirements for educational institutions are set by the Cabinet of Ministers on 24.11.2009. in Regulations No. 1338 "Procedures for Ensuring the Safety of Learners in Educational Institutions and Events Organized by Them". In various issues, both the learners and the pedagogues themselves, with the involvement of external experts, organize theoretical and practical training in security issues. Observance of these regulations is taken into account in the evaluation (accreditation) of the quality of the activities of educational institutions. If deficiencies in safety and support issues are observed in educational institutions, their elimination is monitored. It is a function of the State Education Quality Service. The Ministry of Education and Science implements the project "Development and Implementation of the Education Quality Monitoring System". The education quality monitoring system will be fully operational in the country in 2023. The concept of education quality defined in the project consists of 4 categories and 12 elements. Among other things, security and an inclusive environment are high on the agenda. For example, the category "Relevance" includes the element "Equity and inclusion", while the category "Engaging environment" includes the element "Safety and wellbeing".

2.6 Education personnel

Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to "substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers".

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☐ Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels)
- ☒ Initial training and continuous professional development is provided
- ☒ Minimum standards and qualifications are required for the teaching profession
- ☒ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession
- ☒ Performance monitoring systems
- ☐ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education
- ☐ Other:

- Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:

Initial training and continuous professional development shall be ensured. Each year, the national budget earmarks EUR 1.2 million to provide support for the development of the professional competence of teachers. Key accents: the introduction of new Competency-based content and the development of digital skills. In 2020, an additional EUR 500 000 has been allocated from the national budget for the development of digital skills. Teaching profession requires minimum standards and qualifications Requirements for education and professional qualifications of educator shall be regulated by the Cabinet Measures taken to strengthen the social situation and attractiveness of the teaching profession Revised content and quality of initial teacher education programmes, introduced conditions for the reception

of applicants and uniform requirements for the development of programmes; introduced social guarantees for educators who, in the event of reorganisation or closure of the educational establishment, lose their jobs at pre-retirement age, as well as a timetable for the gradual increase in teacher pay. Performance monitoring systems At the moment, the Ministry is working on a comprehensive education for it, including the development of the teacher quality monitoring system, as well as a tool will be developed to help assess the load, lack, optimal provision of intellectual resources in the education system.

- Have there been instances of discrimination as regards the training for education personnel in your country?

☐ Yes: Has your government addressed this issue?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ No

2.7 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.¹² Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

x Curriculum includes human rights education

x Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education

☐ Other:

2.8 Private education

Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for private education.

- Does your country have a regulatory framework relating to the establishment and functioning of private educational institutions?

Yes x No ☐

¹²

Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

- Please provide a brief description:

Provisions on private educational institutions are included in Education Law <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/50759-education-law> and General Education Law <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/en/id/20243-general-education-law>

- Do legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation¹³ explicitly apply to private educational institutions?

Yes x No ☐

- Please briefly describe what laws, regulations or policies guarantee that the development of private education does not generate discrimination and that private schools offer a relevant alternative in your country:

- Does your country have an education policy framework for minimum educational standards as regards the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children?

Yes ☐ No ☐

2.9 Rights of national minorities

Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. National minorities, who often face language barriers, are among the specific groups referred to in the Convention.

- Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- X Constitutional laws and/or legislation protect the right to education of national minorities
- X Legislation or regulations guarantee the right of national minorities to study in their mother tongue
- X Curriculum is adapted to national minority needs
- X Teachers are trained to adapt to national minority needs

☐ Other:

- Please provide a brief description of the provisions:

Discrimination is prohibited by the Constitution of the Republic of Latvia Section 91 that states that all human beings in Latvia shall be equal before the law and the courts. Human rights shall be realised without discrimination of any kind. <https://likumi.lv/ta/en/id/57980-the-constitution-of-the-republic-of-latvia>
National minorities and their culture is an integral and important component of Latvia's society and cultural space. Latvia's integration policy ensures protection of rights of persons

belonging to national minorities and enjoyment of their culture, language and traditions. These rights are not only written in the constitution, but also vividly practiced in the real life. All Latvia's permanent residents are guaranteed the right to establish their national societies, unions and associations. The State has a duty to facilitate their activities and to provide financial support.

One of the tasks included in the Guidelines on the Development of Education in Latvia for the years 2014-2020 is promotion of multilingual personality both, by learning foreign languages, native language and the State language. Latvia has the second highest multilingualism indicator in the EU.

Bilingual education is an integral part of the Latvian education system, which aims to acquire both the Latvian and minority language skills. It has been consequent and long-term goal of Latvian government.

The Government provides state-funded national minority education programmes in seven minority languages: Russian, Polish, Belarusian, Ukrainian, Estonian, Lithuanian, and Hebrew. In total there are 100 educational institutions that implement minority educational programs

The Ministry of Education and Science has drawn up five model bilingual education curricula for primary schools that differ from each other in terms of the proportion of classes to be taught in the minority language and Latvian or bilingual. National minority schools can opt for one of these curricula or prepare their own. Minority secondary schools have been given 50% (grade 1-6) and 20 % (7-9) of the total number of subjects in the national minority language and free choice is given to the minority schools in determining the subjects which should be taught in the official state language.

About 56 000 pupils are enrolled in national minority education programmes, accounting for 26% of the total number of students.

The quality of education is constantly monitored by the Ministry of Education and Science. Statistical data clearly shows that the examination results in minority schools do not differ substantially from the results observed in previous years. Examination results in some subjects are even better than before.

As a result of successful integration policy, in recent years the Latvian language proficiency among persons belonging to national minorities has improved considerably, especially among the youth. According to the recent study, more than 94% of persons belonging to national minorities can communicate in Latvian.

The state support for education in minority languages in Latvia exceeds that of many other European countries. Latvia's approach and long-term experience in minority education and integration is used by the HCNM as best practice to be introduced in other OSCE countries.

The Government of Latvia has constantly been exerting efforts to promote the dialogue with representatives of national minorities. Consultative bodies are a common practice of local governments. Five advisory councils on national minority issues are currently functioning at the national level – one is the President's Advisory Council on National Minorities, three different committees work under the Ministry of Culture: Advisory Committee of Representatives from Minority Non-governmental Organisations, Advisory Council for Implementation of Roma Integration Policy and Advisory Council for the Integration of Third-country Nationals.

The Ministry of Education and Science has established the Consultative Council on issues of national minority education. This institution helps to maintain a dialogue between the

Ministry of Education and Science, students and teachers of national minority schools, parents' organizations and NGO's. The Head of Roma Community in Latvia is a member of the Advisory Council on Minorities Education under the Ministry of Education and Science.

- As regards the educational standards in educational institutions run by minorities, please describe the existing legal and policy framework:

Information could also cover the language facilities, such as the availability of teaching in the mother tongue of the students, use of teaching of languages in education policy, multilingualism, etc.

616 educational institutions implemented the education programme in Latvian;
100 educational institutions implemented minority education programmes (study language: Russian (90), Polish (4), Ukrainian (1), Belorussian (1), Hebrew (2), Lithuanian (1); Estonian (1));
56 dual-stream schools, implementing education programmes both in Latvian and Russian;
11 private educational institutions implementing an education programme in Russian;
8 private educational institutions implementing an education programme both in Latvian and Russian;
26 private educational institutions implementing an education programme in Latvian.

2.10 Rights of refugees and migrants

The rights of refugees and migrants are not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the Convention and Recommendation call on states to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education based notably on national origin.¹⁴ In this context, a number of Member States that participated in the 9th Consultation reported on measures adopted to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education. Growing displacement and influx of refugees worldwide and the emergence of major educational challenges in this area, as well as the frameworks recently adopted by the international community,¹⁵ demonstrate the opportunity for states to report on measures adopted to include refugees and migrants in their educational systems.

Besides, this aspect also corresponds to SDG target 4.5, which calls on states to "ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable", including "children in vulnerable situations", and covers the majority of SDG4 targets.

- Please briefly describe the existing legal and policy framework that protects the right to quality education for refugees and migrants in your country.

The Asylum Law states that the Cabinet of Ministers shall determine the procedures by which a minor asylum seeker shall be provided with opportunities for acquiring education. On the basis of the foregoing, the Cabinet has issued Regulation No 488 of 26 July 2016 "Procedures for the Provision of Minor Asylum Seekers with Opportunities for Acquiring Education". The asylum seeker shall be provided with preparation from the age of 5 for the acquisition of basic education and an opportunity to acquire basic education and general education (hereinafter - the general education) in accordance with the laws and regulations

¹⁴ Articles/Paragraphs 1 and 3.

¹⁵ Namely the 2016 New York Declaration for Refugees and Migrants, the Comprehensive Refugee Response Framework and the two Global Compacts on refugees and for safe, orderly and regular migration.

regarding the procedures by which the educatees are enrolled in the general educational institutions and expelled from them, and also moved up into the next grade.

- Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

x Inclusion in mainstream education

x Provision of language courses

x Specific training for educational staff

x Initiatives addressing discrimination and promoting cultural diversity and mutual acceptance

☐ Alternative administrative procedure (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.)

x Accelerated learning programmes

x Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes

x Financial support

☐ Other innovative measures:

Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:

The Ministry shall determine the educational institution which provides the asylum seeker with the opportunities for the acquisition of general education by co-ordinating it with the founder of educational institution. In order to provide the asylum seeker with the general education, the educational institution shall conclude an agreement with the Ministry regarding granting of financing. An estimate of expenditure regarding expenditure items for the provision of remuneration for teachers and the list of teaching aids approved by the head of the educational institution shall be appended to the agreement.

The educational institution shall, until commencement of the acquisition of education, develop an in-depth plan for the acquisition of subjects by the asylum seeker for a period of time which is determined in the agreement. The asylum seeker shall be provided with an opportunity to finish the commenced acquisition of general education also after reaching the age of 18 years. The Ministry shall organise the development and issuance of teaching aids suitable for educational programmes for the acquisition of Latvian in order to provide the asylum seeker with the opportunities for the acquisition of general education.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments and to remove the obstacles encountered

1. Challenges and obstacles

1.1 Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☐ Challenges related to equitable access and inclusion in education (such as poverty and socio-economic factors, cultural and traditional attitudes, remoteness, migration and displacement, etc.)

- ☐ Challenges related to the quality of education (such as shortages of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff, non-supportive or inadequate teaching and learning as well as school environment, etc.)

- ☐ Challenges relating to the system and governance (such as budgetary constraints, lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data, absence of supportive/inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment, lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels, etc.)

- ☐ Other:

- 1.2 Please provide a brief assessment of the effectiveness of the methods introduced to remove the obstacles encountered:

Latvia works towards the implementation of inclusive education. High quality public education for all students, regardless of their socioeconomic conditions, functional status and place of residence, is the instrument for contributing to the equality and social inclusion. Education Development Guidelines 2014-2020 stipulate measures for improving the content of preschool, primary and general education, raising professional competence of teachers, as well as ensuring inclusive education. Guidelines are currently being revised for the next period of 2021-2027. The Latvian education system is currently undergoing a curriculum reform for general education, moving to a skills education that raises conceptually other requirements in the preparation of young teachers and teaching workforce, as well as the professional development of existing teachers with regard to the new educational content. Updated skills education focuses on the development of basic skills and intermoding competences for human capacity, ensuring high quality education at all levels of education (i.e. pre-primary, primary, secondary and higher education) and in all forms of education (general education, vocational education and academic education). The successful introduction of modern skills education is a prerequisite for the training in conceptually new quality. According to the Government Action Plan, the task of setting up a updated and efficient network of schools is the subject of a review of the school network, which will affect the workload of teachers and will therefore require teachers with more professional competence. Currently, about 30% of teachers work in schools before retirement and retirement age. This means that this group should be replaced in the next 8-10 years, while in the future the generational changeover will take place more gradually and the demand for the preparation of new educators will decrease.

2. Awareness-raising

UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (several items could be ticked/mentioned)

x Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages

☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education

☐ Increased public awareness through advocacy material on the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education

x Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments

☐ Other:

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